myself. How ridiculous it was.

It finally came to an end some weeks later when I went over the notes. I found that I had taken as much as thirty-five thousand words from a single book and that I had in excess of two million words of notes altogether. I started indexing the notes toward the end of February, and that was the giveaway. It was clear that the indexing was an impossible job, and the whole project suddenly faded and died. I doubt that I ever wasted so much time on so futile a project in my life—but at least I learned how not to write a nonfiction book, so perhaps it wasn't all that futile after all.

On February 4, I visited Campbell and handed over "Now You See It—" While there, I picked up an advance copy of the March 1947 Astounding, which had "Little Lost Robot" 3 in it.

For the first time, however, Campbell was not completely satisfied with a Foundation story. We disagreed on the ending.

After all, I had grown a little weary of the Foundation and all its works. I had been working on it, on and off, for five years. I had written seven stories, totaling about 185,000 words. I felt it was time to end the thing and get on to something new. Therefore I rounded off "Now You See It—" in such a way as to make it a reasonable ending of the series.

Campbell would have none of it. After he read the story, he told me I could not use the ending as I had it. I had to make the story open-ended and continue the series. He was quite firm about it and I still wasn't in any position to brave Campbell's displeasure.

I rewrote "Now You See It—" according to instructions, the task taking me but a day, and brought it in again on the tenth. Campbell accepted the new version at once and on February 14, 1947, a check for $500 arrived. It came on the fifth anniversary of my blind date with Gertrude.

3 See I, Robot.

The $500 made me feel prosperous indeed. The next day we bought a mink-dyed opossum fur coat for Gertrude for $200. It was our first real splurge and it made me feel like a "good provider."

My parents were feeling prosperous, too. At just about this time they were